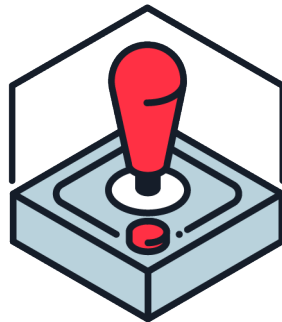




Video Game Metadata Schema: Controlled Vocabulary for MOOD

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GAMER
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<https://github.com/uwgamergroup/vocabulary-mood>

Version History

3.1: June 2015

3.2: September 2024

3.2: December 2024, Formatting update: Updated reference structure for improved visual clarity and ease of use, with no changes to content. Table formatting was removed, and relationships between terms are now displayed hierarchically through indentation, with narrower terms shown as subsets of broader terms. Included relevant term relationships (SN, USE, USE FOR, RT) as appropriate.

Abbreviation Key

The following abbreviations are used throughout:

SN: Scope note

USE: Preferred term (See)

USE FOR: Equivalent terms; lead-in terms

RT: Related terms (See also)

Controlled Vocabulary for Mood

Adventurous

SN: Games that engage the player through exploration, risk-taking, and overcoming obstacles.

Examples: *The Legend of Zelda*; *Tomb Raider*; *Uncharted*

Aggressive

SN: Games in which the focus is on forceful, combative actions.

Examples: *Mad World*; *Mortal Kombat*; *Manhunt*

Apocalyptic

USE: **Dark**

Bleak

USE: **Dark**

Bright

USE: **Light-hearted**

Calm

USE: **Peaceful**

Carefree

USE: **Light-hearted**

Cheerful

USE: **Light-hearted**

Competitive

SN: Games in which the focus is on competition between other players, either real or artificial.

Examples: *Super Smash Bros. Brawl*; *Unreal Tournament 3*; *Forza Motorsport 4*

Comradery

SN: Games in which positive social bonding occurs, either with other players or in-game characters.

Examples: *Brothers: A Tale of Two Sons*; *Grandia*; *Destiny*

Cozy

SN: Games that foster a sense of warmth, comfort, and relaxation, often through inviting environments, gentle gameplay, and soothing aesthetics.

RT: **Cute, Light-Hearted, Peaceful**

Examples: *Animal Crossing: New Horizons*; *Harvest Moon: Light of Hope*

Creative

USE: **Imaginative**

Cute

SN: Games with a charming, childish, and/or delightful quality.

USE FOR: **Sweet**

RT: **Cozy**

Examples: *Pokemon Red/Blue*; *Kirby's Dreamland*; *Bubble Bobble*

Cynical

USE: **Dark**

Dark

SN: Games with a grim atmosphere that focus on dismal, gloomy, and/or depressing circumstances.

USE FOR: **Apocalyptic, bleak, cynical, gloomy, gritty, somber**

Examples: *Bioshock*; *Dark Souls*; *Batman: Arkham Asylum*

Disturbing

USE: **Horror**

Eerie

SN: Games that create a sense of unease or discomfort, often through unsettling atmospheres, ambiguous threats, and a feeling of something being subtly, but profoundly, wrong.

USE FOR: **Unsettling, Liminal**

RT: **Horror**

Examples: *Oxenfree*; *What Remains of Edith Finch*

Erotic

USE: **Sensual**

Funny

USE: **Humorous**

Gloomy

USE: **Dark**

Gritty

USE: **Dark**

Horror

SN: Games that frighten players by playing on primal fears, inducing feelings of horror and terror.

USE FOR: **Disturbing, Macabre, Paranoid, Scary, Unsettling**

RT: **Eerie**

Examples: *Silent Hill*; *Resident Evil*; *Outlast*

Humorous

SN: Games that possess a funny, amusing quality.

USE FOR: **Funny, Silly, Witty**

RT: **Light-hearted**

Examples: *Strong Bad's Cool Game for Attractive People*; *Sam and Max Hit the Road*; *Monkey Island*

Imaginative

SN: Games where the primary focus is creative expression of the player, through world-building, character-building, and/or creative problem-solving.

USE FOR: **Creative**

Examples: *Little Big Planet*; *Scribblenauts*; *Minecraft*; *Spore*

Immersive

SN: Games that mentally transport or transfix the player to the world or realm presented in the game.

Examples: *Dragon Age: Origins*; *Shenmue*; *Heavy Rain*

Intense

SN: Games with an extreme, high-energy tone, meant to inspire strong emotions in the player (stress, determination, a sense of urgency, etc.).

Examples: *Metal Gear Solid: Revengeance*; *Devil May Cry*; *God of War 2*

Light-hearted

SN: Games that possess a cheerful, carefree quality. Examples: *Harvest Moon*; *Angry Birds*; *Peggle*

USE FOR: **Bright, Carefree, Cheerful, Optimistic**

RT: **Cozy, Humorous**

Liminal

USE: **Eerie**

Macabre

USE: **Horror**

Meditative

USE: **Peaceful**

Mellow

USE: **Peaceful**

Mysterious

SN: Games that invoke curiosity and/or suspense through the investigation of the unknown (a crime, a secret, a strange occurrence, etc.).

USE FOR: **Suspenseful**

Examples: *Gabriel Knight*; *Myst*; *The Vanishing of Ethan Carter*

Nostalgic

USE: **Sentimental**

Offbeat

USE: **Quirky**

Optimistic

USE: **Light-hearted**

Paranoid

USE: **Horror**

Peaceful

SN: Games that invoke a sense of calm.

USE FOR: **Calm, Meditative, Mellow, Relaxed**

RT: **Cozy**

Examples: *Flower*; *Journey*; *Zen Bound*

Quirky

SN: Games with an unusual or peculiar quality.

USE FOR: **Offbeat, Whimsical**

Examples: *Braid*; *Paper Mario*; *Katamari Damacy*

Relaxed

USE: **Peaceful**

Romantic

SN: Games where a substantial focus is on romantic relationships and the pursuit of love.

Examples: *Sentimental Graffiti*; *Shin Megami Tensei: Persona 4*; *Hatoful Boyfriend*

Sad

SN: Games that evoke feelings of sorrow, loss, or melancholy

Examples: *The Last of Us*; *Final Fantasy 7*

Sarcastic

SN: Games that have a sharp, satirical, caustic tone.

USE FOR: **Satirical**

Examples: *Grand Theft Auto 3*; *Fallout 3*; *Saints Row the Third*

Satirical

USE: **Sarcastic**

Scary

USE: **Horror**

Sensual

SN: Games that invoke physical or sexual pleasure.

USE FOR: **Erotic, Sexy**

Examples: *Bayonetta*; *Catherine*

Sentimental

SN: Games with feelings of nostalgia, affection, or tenderness, evoked by a deep connection to the game's themes or memories.

USE FOR: **Nostalgic**

Examples: *Unpacking*

Sexy

USE: **Sensual**

Silly

USE: **Humorous**

Solitary

SN: Games in which the player feels isolated or alone.

Examples: *Metroid*; *Shadow of the Colossus*; *P.T.*

Somber

USE: **Dark**

Suspenseful

USE: **Mysterious**

Sweet

USE: **Cute**

Unsettling

USE: **Eerie**

Whimsical

USE: **Quirky**